

sports schedule

Business Plan (why focus on sports)

Here is a summary of the annual sporting event analysis, focusing on volume, seasonality, and schedule density.

1. The Big Picture: Annual Volume

When combining the schedules of all major leagues analyzed (including qualifiers, group stages, and prelims), the total volume of high-level sporting events is massive.

- **Total Annual Events: ~16,500+** matches/races per year.
- **Average Per Month: ~1,375** matches/races.

2. Volume Breakdown by Tier

We can categorize these leagues into three distinct "operating models" based on how frequently they generate content.

Tier 1: The "Daily Grinders" (High Volume)

These leagues rely on daily inventory, often playing multiple games per day.

- **Esports (Tier 1): ~6,500 matches** (The highest volume due to concurrent global tournaments and qualifiers).
- **MLB: ~2,470 games** (The highest volume traditional sport; plays nearly every day for 6 months).
- **European Soccer: ~2,130 matches** (Top 5 Leagues + Champions League).
- **NHL: ~1,400 games** (High density, Oct–June).
- **NBA: ~1,315 games** (High density, Oct–June).

Tier 2: The "Steady Flows" (Medium Volume)

- **Cricket: ~600 matches** (International Tests/ODIs/T20s + IPL).
- **MLS: ~520 matches** (Feb–Dec schedule).
- **UFC: ~500 fights** (Approx. 42 cards/year, ~12 fights per card).
- **Olympics: ~500 matches** (Annualized average; heavily concentrated in July/Aug every 4 years).

Tier 3: "Appointment Viewing" (Low Frequency)

These sports play once a week (or less), making every event critical.

- **NFL: 285 games** (Short, high-intensity season).
- **World Cup: ~250 matches** (Annualized average including global qualifiers).
- **NASCAR: ~38 races** (Feb–Nov).
- **Formula 1: ~24 races** (Mar–Dec).

3. Calendar Analysis: Peaks and Valleys

The Busiest Month: October (The "Sports Equinox")

October is the calendar's peak for **variety**. It is the only time where the "Big 4" North American leagues (NFL, NBA, MLB, NHL) overlap with European Soccer, NASCAR, F1, and major Esports tournaments.

The Highest Volume Month: April

April is the statistical peak for **quantity** of games.

- **Why?** The MLB season is fully active (baseball provides the most daily games of any sport), coinciding with the intense final stretch of the NBA and NHL regular seasons and European Soccer leagues.

The Quietest Month: February

Despite hosting the Super Bowl, February has the lowest total number of events.

- **Why?** MLB and MLS are inactive. The NFL plays only 1 game. The calendar is driven almost entirely by the NBA, NHL, and European Soccer.

4. Critical "Gap Fillers"

Two major gaps exist in the traditional sports calendar, which are filled by specific competitions:

1. The Summer Gap (June–August):

- With the NBA, NFL, NHL, and Euro Soccer on break, the volume is sustained by **MLB** (daily), **MLS**, **Esports**, **F1**, and **NASCAR**.

2. The Weekend Anchor:

- While leagues like the NBA and MLB spread games across the week, **Formula 1**, **NASCAR**, and the **NFL** dominate Sundays, serving as the "anchor" events that dictate the viewing schedule for fans.